HOOK

A platform just drew a line on AI agents

Internal automation is fine. Acting on your behalf externally is not.

- Story broke in the last few hours, spreading fast on HN
- It's not an anti-AI move, it's a trust move

WHAT'S HAPPENING

The split: automate vs. act autonomously

Using AI to work faster inside your own systems is different from an agent taking actions on other people's platforms without a human checking each step.

- Internal workflows: your data, your risk, your call
- External actions: agent behaves like a verified human user
- Platforms can't yet tell the difference reliably

WHY IT'S BLOWING UP

It exposes a gap nobody solved yet

Agent capability moved faster than platform trust infrastructure.

- Agents can technically log in, click, submit, message
- Platforms have no standard way to verify agent identity
- Builders get blindsided when agents get flagged or banned

MECHANISM

How platforms try to catch agents

Most detection isn't about the AI model. It's about behavior patterns.

- Timing: agents act faster and more consistently than humans
- Volume: agents repeat actions at a scale humans don't
- Session signals: device, browser, API patterns look different
- Policy: terms of service simply ban non-human actors

LESSON 1

Internal automation is still wide open

The backlash is aimed at agents acting externally, not at automating your own stack.

- CRM updates, data sync, internal approvals: still fair game
- This is where most practical ROI already lives
- No platform is blocking you from automating your own tools

LESSON 2

Human-in-the-loop isn't a weakness, it's the design

The agents getting flagged are the ones trying to look fully autonomous.

- A review step before external actions reduces platform risk
- It also protects you from an agent doing something costly
- Full autonomy sounds impressive, it's rarely what you need

LESSON 3

Build for the platform's rules, not around them

Workflows that respect rate limits, identity, and terms of service last longer than clever workarounds.

- Check a platform's API and automation policy before building
- Favor official APIs and webhooks over scraping or spoofing
- Assume detection will improve, design for that now

TAKEAWAY

Automate the work, not the trust boundary

The real opportunity right now is connecting your internal tools well, with a person approving anything that touches someone else's platform.

- Map which steps are internal vs. external facing
- Keep humans approving external actions for now
- Internal automation still has huge untapped time savings

CTA

What's the most manual part of your workflow?

Tell me what you're doing by hand right now.

- I'll tell you honestly if it's a good fit for automation